HAIR LOSS
10

Clascoterone

Cortexolone 17α-propionate, a steroid that blocks the androgen receptor in skin where it is applied



CLASS
Topical androgen receptor inhibitor

STUDIED FOR
Acne, male pattern hair loss

HUMAN EVIDENCE
Large trials; FDA approved (acne)

US STATUS
FDA approved (Winlevi), acne only

STUDIED FOR

- Acne — HUMAN
- Male pattern loss — HUMAN

Hair results not published. Two Phase 3 hair-loss trials in about 1,465 men are completed; no results are posted or published.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Clascoterone ▶ Androgen receptor ▶ Blocks DHT action ▶ Skin and follicle

- **Androgen receptor inhibitor,** per the label; acne mechanism unknown
- **Does not lower** testosterone or DHT; blocks their action where applied
- **In lab-grown scalp cells,** it blocked androgen-driven gene activity
- **In people,** the effect on hair is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- 2 Phase 3 acne trials, 1,440 people
- Acne success 18.4–20.3% vs 6.5–9.0% (vehicle)
- Hair: 2 Phase 3 trials, results not posted

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Effect on hair loss
- Safety of the 5% solution
- Half-life in people
- Excretion in people

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
Not established (not on the label)

ROUTES STUDIED
On the skin (1% cream); 5% scalp solution in trials

PHARMACOKINETICS
Steady state by day 5; possible metabolite cortexolone

SOLD AS
Prescription cream (Winlevi)

MONITORED IN TRIALS
HPA axis suppression, potassium, skin reactions

SPORT (WADA)
Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved for acne, age 12+ (2020); not hair loss
EMA	Authorised for acne (Oct 2025)
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Winlevi prescribing information (DailyMed), Jan 2025
2. Hebert et al., JAMA Dermatol, two Phase 3 acne trials, Jun 2020
3. ClinicalTrials.gov, SCALP1 (NCT05910450) and SCALP2 (NCT05914805), accessed Nov 2026

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